

is typically available as an innocuous-sounding app such as 'Backup' or 'Cleaner'. Once installed, the spyware downloads and loads a second 'license verification'



page that validates some abort criteria on the hardware.

"If given the all-clear, the second stage would then root the device with known exploits and begin to exfiltrate device data to a command and control server," the team, comprising Android Security's Megan Ruthven and the Threat Analysis Group's Ken

Bozdak and Neel Mehta, have written in a blog post.

The second stage of Lipizzan is capable of performing and exfiltrating results of tasks such as call recording, VoIP, voice recording, location monitoring, screenshots capturing and taking photos. Additionally, it is capable of helping attackers retrieve data from apps like Gmail, Hangouts, KakaoTalk, LinkedIn, Messenger, Skype, Snapchat, Viber and WhatsApp, among others.

Google researchers found the presence of Lipizzan while investigating Chrysaor — a recently emerged spyware that was believed to be written by the NSO Group. Once spotted clearly, Google's Play Protect service released a notification on all affected devices and removed the apps with Lipizzan from the online store.

Moreover, Google has enhanced Play Protect's capabilities to continuously detect and block targeted spyware on the Android platform. Developers need to use official resources only when building their apps to ensure a secured and safe experience.

GitHub adds new features to grow community engagements

Supporting open source efforts by developers, GitHub has brought out a list of new features to enhance community engagements around your projects.

"Thanks to some subtle (and not so subtle) improvements in the past few months, it's now easier to make your first contribution, launch a new project or grow your community on GitHub," the GitHub team wrote in a blog post.



First on the list of new features is contributor badges.

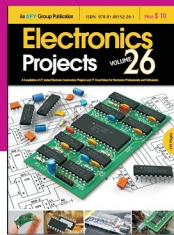
Being a maintainer, you can now see a 'first-time contribution' badge that helps you review pull requests from users who have contributed to your projects for the first time. The 'first-time contributor' badge becomes a 'contributor' badge in the comments section once the pull request is merged. Furthermore, you can expose the information in the additional flag via the GraphQL API.

Apart from providing badges to your contributors, you have been provided with the option to add a licence file to your project using a new licence picker. This new section helps you pick an appropriate licence by providing the full text. It also allows you to customise any applicable fields prior to committing the file or opening a pull request.

As privacy is one of the major factors preventing you from contributing to a new project, GitHub has added the ability to let you keep your email address private. GitHub also provides a warning that lets you make an informed decision about contributing to a project you were blocked from previously. Moreover, blocked users on the platform will not be able to comment on issues or pull requests in third-party repositories.

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